



# Free Teacher STARTER PACK

Screen-free environmental learning for ages 6–11

## INCLUDES

ready-to-run outdoor mission · student evidence sheet  
discussion prompts · sustainability challenge  
reusable lesson-planning template

For teachers, homeschoolers and other adults leading learning.

# The GSA lesson structure

Gaia's Secret Agents works best when children are given a clear role and a real question to investigate. The adult leads the session; the story simply gives the learning a purpose.

## 1 • OBJECTIVE

Give one clear mission: what are students trying to find out?

## 2 • OBSERVE

Look closely at a real place, object or system before explaining it.

## 3 • EVIDENCE

Record something concrete: a count, sketch, comparison, measurement or observation.

## 4 • REPORT BACK

Ask students to explain what the evidence suggests and what they would investigate next.

## Before you go outside

- Choose a safe, clearly bounded observation area.
- Set the regrouping point and time before students move.
- Observe living things without handling, moving rocks/logs, disturbing nests or feeding wildlife.
- Adapt for weather, accessibility, allergies and local site conditions.
- One focused task is enough. You do not need to fill the whole lesson with activities.

## FIELD MISSION

# Operation: Hidden Habitat

**Mission objective:** Compare two small outdoor zones and use evidence to decide which one appears to provide more useful habitat features for small living things.

**Time:** 20-30 minutes   **Materials:** one field sheet and pencil per student/pair   **Location:** school grounds, yard or park

**Do not:** move rocks or logs, pull plants, touch wildlife, disturb nests, enter drains/water, or collect living things.

## Briefing

Agents, Headquarters needs a habitat report. Two places can be only a few metres apart and still offer very different conditions for living things. Your job is to compare two small zones and report what the evidence shows.

## Run the mission

- **Choose Zone A.** Mark a small observation area roughly one metre across. Do not disturb it.
- **Choose Zone B.** Pick a nearby area that looks different - for example, sunnier/shadier, lawn/garden edge, dry/damp, open/sheltered.
- **Observe for five minutes.** Record visible habitat features and signs of life. Signs may include insects seen, bird activity, webbing, holes, leaf damage, tracks or other evidence - without touching.
- **Compare.** Use the field sheet to identify at least three differences.
- **Report back.** Decide which zone appears to provide more habitat features and support the answer with evidence.

# Operation: Hidden Habitat - Evidence Sheet

Agent / group: \_\_\_\_\_ Date: \_\_\_\_\_

COPY FOR STUDENTS: Teachers may photocopy this page for learners in their own class or homeschool group.

## ZONE A

Describe this place:

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- ☐ Shade
- ☐ Plants
- ☐ Shelter
- ☐ Leaf litter
- ☐ Moisture
- ☐ Signs of life

## ZONE B

Describe this place:

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- ☐ Shade
- ☐ Plants
- ☐ Shelter
- ☐ Leaf litter
- ☐ Moisture
- ☐ Signs of life

## Three differences we noticed

1. \_\_\_\_\_
2. \_\_\_\_\_
3. \_\_\_\_\_

## OUR REPORT TO HEADQUARTERS

Which zone seems to offer more useful habitat features?

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# Turn observations into thinking

The mission is not finished when the field sheet is full. Use the report-back conversation to help students separate what they *observed* from what they *inferred*.

**Q1** What did you actually observe, and what did you infer from it?

**Q2** Which piece of evidence most influenced your conclusion?

**Q3** Did the zone with more plants always show more signs of life? Why might that vary?

**Q4** What could change the result at a different time of day, season or weather condition?

**Q5** What evidence would you collect next if you had another ten minutes?

**Q6** How could we improve habitat without disturbing the organisms already using the space?

## Optional curriculum extensions

- **Science:** classify habitat features and discuss needs of living things.
- **Maths:** repeat observations using tally counts, simple proportions or measurements.
- **English:** write a short evidence-based field report using 'I observed...' and 'This suggests...'.
- **HASS / Geography:** map habitat-rich and habitat-poor areas around the school grounds.

# The Evidence-to-Action Challenge

Sustainability works better when students investigate first and act second. This short challenge can follow Operation: Hidden Habitat or stand alone.

**Challenge:** Choose one small school-ground area. Identify one evidence-based improvement that could make the space more useful for people, plants or wildlife - without creating a new safety problem.

## 1. NOTICE

What is happening now? Record two observations before proposing anything.

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## 2. NAME THE NEED

What specific problem or opportunity does the evidence suggest?

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## 3. COMPARE OPTIONS

List two possible improvements. What are the benefits and trade-offs of each?

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## 4. CHOOSE

Which option is realistic for this place, and why?

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## 5. CHECK

What would you measure later to know whether the change helped?

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**Teacher note:** An acceptable outcome can be 'we need more information.' Students do not need to complete an environmental action every lesson. Understanding a system, evaluating evidence and identifying uncertainty are meaningful learning outcomes.

# Build your own GSA-style lesson

Use this one-page planning frame to turn an ordinary topic into a focused, screen-free investigation.

## MISSION OBJECTIVE

*What should students find out, compare, test or explain?*

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## REAL-WORLD TARGET

*What place, object, organism, pattern or system will they observe?*

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## EVIDENCE

*What will students record - tally, sketch, measurement, map, comparison or written observation?*

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## REPORT-BACK QUESTION

*What single question will require students to use their evidence?*

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## SAFETY / ACCESS

*What boundaries, weather, accessibility or site conditions need adapting?*

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## NEXT STEP

*What would students investigate next, or what proportionate action could follow?*

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# Teacher Use & Next Steps

**Classroom copying permission:** you may print or photocopy the student Evidence Sheet (page 4) for learners in your own class or homeschool group. You may print the teacher pages for your own teaching use. Please do not upload or redistribute the complete pack publicly.

## Schools & Teachers

[gaiassecretagents.com/schools.html](https://gaiassecretagents.com/schools.html)

Teacher sample, school-use information and licensing enquiries.

## Outdoor Learning Guide

[gaiassecretagents.com/outdoor-learning-activities-primary-school.html](https://gaiassecretagents.com/outdoor-learning-activities-primary-school.html)

Eight low-prep primary-school outdoor learning activities.

## Sustainability Guide

[gaiassecretagents.com/sustainability-activities-primary-school.html](https://gaiassecretagents.com/sustainability-activities-primary-school.html)

Nine sustainability activities built around systems, evidence and action.

## Free Activities Archive

[gaiassecretagents.com/free-activities-guides.html](https://gaiassecretagents.com/free-activities-guides.html)

All current public GSA field guides in one place.

## Interested in paid GSA resources for a class or school?

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## Observe · Explore · Protect

Gaia's Secret Agents · Brisbane, Queensland, Australia